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| <b>Contact</b>            | Burgemeester Oudlaan 50<br>Erasmus School of Economics<br>Erasmus University Rotterdam<br>3062 PA Rotterdam, The Netherlands                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Office: E-building E2-42<br>Phone: +31 (0) 63 976 0299<br>E-mail: <a href="mailto:hou@ese.eur.nl">hou@ese.eur.nl</a><br>Website: <a href="https://wei-hou-finance.github.io/">https://wei-hou-finance.github.io/</a> |
| <b>Research Interests</b> | Empirical corporate finance, labor-market institutions, corporate governance, firm organization                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Education</b>          | <b>School of Economics, Erasmus University</b><br>Ph.D. in Finance                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Rotterdam, Netherlands<br>2023 – 2027 (expected)                                                                                                                                                                     |
|                           | <b>University Carlos III of Madrid (UC3M)</b><br>Mphil in Business and Finance                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Madrid, Spain<br>2021 – 2023                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|                           | <b>Tilburg University</b><br>Msc in Finance                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Tilburg, Netherlands<br>2019 – 2021                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|                           | <b>Nankai University</b><br>Bsc in Business Administration                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Tianjin, China<br>2015 – 2019                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Publication</b>        | <b>Ranking finance conferences: An update</b><br>with Esad Smajlbegovic and Daniel Urban<br><i>Journal of Empirical Finance</i> , 2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Working Papers</b>     | <b>On the Program: A Gender Equality Initiative and Professional Visibility at Academic Conferences</b><br>With Marina Gertsberg, Esad Smajlbegovic, Daniel Urban, and Patrick Verwijmeren.<br><i>Revise &amp; Resubmit, Research Policy</i><br><i>Abstract:</i> Persistent gender disparities characterize scientific careers. We study a gender equality initiative implemented at a leading academic conference, a key stage in researchers' careers where visibility, reputation, and professional networks are shaped. Using a difference-in-differences design that compares two major conferences within the same discipline, we show that a time-limited initiative encouraging the appointment of women as paper discussants led to a sharp but temporary increase in female representation in this prestigious role. The increase did not come at the expense of quality: female discussants on the conference program during the initiative had stronger publication records and comparable expertise-paper matches. The initiative increased female representation across the seniority distribution, with the largest gains among senior women, where pre-initiative underrepresentation was most severe. Senior women also took on a disproportionate number of conference roles. Over time, the pool of selected women broadened modestly to include scholars from lower-ranked institutions, and matched evidence is consistent with subsequent recognition gains for both senior and junior women. Our findings show that leadership-driven gender equality initiatives can meaningfully alter representation in high-profile academic roles, but that their effects are not necessarily self-sustaining.<br><i>Presentations:</i> ESE Cheapthrills 2024, TU Munich 2025, University of Melbourne 2025, FBA Conference 2025. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|                           | <b>Noncompete Agreements and Internal Labor Markets</b><br><i>Abstract:</i> This paper studies how labor mobility restrictions shape firms' internal allocation of human capital. Exploiting staggered state-level variation in noncompete agreement (NCA) enforceability and matched employee-level data from Revelio Labs, I show that tighter restrictions increase internal promotions, with effects concentrated among workers in operations- and production-related functions and knowledge workers. Organizational hierarchy also adjusts: small establishments add hierarchical layers and extend career ladders, while large establishments become flatter. At the firm level, NCA-sensitive firms increase assets and SG&A per employee. I provide evidence that hold-up alleviation and internal tournament incentives drive these patterns. Together, the findings show that NCAs reshape the organizational structures through which firms develop and allocate human capital.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

*Presentations:* Tinbergen Institute Jamboree, ESE Cheap Thrills, Spanish Finance Forum PhD Day, Corporate Finance Day 2026 (scheduled), FMA 2026 (scheduled), and 7th RCF-ECGI Conference (scheduled)

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| <b>Teaching Experience</b> | <b>Thesis Supervisor, Department of Business Economics</b> 2024–2027                                                                                                                    |
|                            | FEM11067: Master’s Thesis Financial Economics<br>FEB13100: Bachelor Thesis<br>Supervise master’s and bachelor’s theses                                                                  |
|                            | <b>Teaching Assistant, Department of Business Economics</b> Fall 2024–2027                                                                                                              |
|                            | FEM11118: Advanced Corporate Finance and Governance<br><i>Average course rating: 8.5/10   Average student rating: 4.4/5</i>                                                             |
| <b>Honors &amp; Awards</b> | National Beca Scholarship-Government of Spain 2022–2023                                                                                                                                 |
|                            | National Beca Scholarship-Government of Spain 2021–2022                                                                                                                                 |
|                            | CentER Research Assistance Honors, Tilburg University 2020                                                                                                                              |
|                            | University Scholarship, Nankai University 2018                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Presentations</b>       | PhD Seminars at RSM, PhD Workshop at 33rd Spanish Finance Forum, Tinbergen Jamboree Seminar, ESE Cheapthrills, 23rd Benelux Corporate Finance Days, 7th RCF-ECGI, FMA 2026 2026         |
|                            | Seminars at University of Melbourne, Tinbergen Jamboree Seminar, TU Munich 2025, FBA Conference 2025, ESE Research Retreat 2025                                                         |
|                            | ESE Cheapthrills, ESE Research Retreat 2024                                                                                                                                             |
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| <b>Journal Referee</b>     | <i>Review of Managerial Science</i>                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Skills</b>              | <b>Programming:</b> R, Stata, LaTeX, Python                                                                                                                                             |
|                            | <b>Languages:</b> Mandarin (native), English (proficient)                                                                                                                               |
| <b>References</b>          | <b>Patrick Verwijmeren</b><br>Professor of Finance<br>Erasmus University Rotterdam<br>Erasmus School of Economics<br><a href="mailto:verwijmeren@ese.eur.nl">verwijmeren@ese.eur.nl</a> |
|                            | <b>Daniel Urban</b><br>Associate Professor of Finance<br>Erasmus University Rotterdam<br>Erasmus School of Economics<br><a href="mailto:urban@ese.eur.nl">urban@ese.eur.nl</a>          |
|                            | <b>Marina Gertsberg</b><br>Assistant Professor (Senior Lecturer) in Finance<br>University of Melbourne<br><a href="mailto:mgertsberg@unimelb.edu.au">mgertsberg@unimelb.edu.au</a>      |